webuse — Use dataset from Stata website

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Description

`webuse` *filename* loads the specified dataset, obtaining it over the web. By default, datasets are obtained from https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/. If *filename* is specified without a suffix, `.dta` is assumed.

`webuse query` reports the URL from which datasets will be obtained.

`webuse set` allows you to specify the URL to be used as the source for datasets. `webuse set` without arguments resets the source to https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/.

You can see lists of available dataset names for each manual in your browser at https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/ or from within Stata at `help dta_manuals`.

Quick start

Load example `nlswork.dta` dataset from default Stata Press website

```
webuse nlswork
```

Same as above, but clear current dataset from memory first

```
webuse nlswork, clear
```

Change URL for data downloads to http://www.myuniversity.edu/mycourse

```
webuse set www.myuniversity.edu/mycourse
```

Reset source for datasets to Stata Press

```
webuse set
```

Report current URL from which datasets will be obtained

```
webuse query
```

Menu

File > Example datasets...

Syntax

Load dataset over the web

```
webuse ["]filename["] [ , clear ]
```

Report URL from which datasets will be obtained

```
webuse query
```

Specify URL from which dataset will be obtained

```
webuse set [https://]url[/]
```

```
webuse set [http://]url[/]
```

Reset URL to default

```
webuse set
```

Option

`clear` specifies that it is okay to replace the data in memory, even though the current data have not been saved to disk.

Remarks and examples

Remarks are presented under the following headings:

Typical use
A note concerning example datasets
Redirecting the source

Typical use

In the examples in the Stata manuals, we see things such as

```
. use https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/lifeexp
```

The above is used to load—in this instance—the dataset `lifeexp.dta`. You can type that, and it will work:

```
. use https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/lifeexp
(Life expectancy, 1998)
```

Or you may simply type

```
. webuse lifeexp
(Life expectancy, 1998)
```

`webuse` is a synonym for `use https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/`.

A note concerning example datasets

The datasets used to demonstrate Stata are often fictional. If you want to know whether a dataset is real or fictional, and its history, load the dataset and type

```
. notes
```

A few datasets have no notes. This means that the datasets are believed to be real but that they were created so long ago that information about their original source has been lost. Treat such datasets as if they were fictional.

Redirecting the source

By default, `webuse` obtains datasets from https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/, but you can change that. Say that the site http://www.zzz.edu/users/sue/ has several datasets that you wish to explore. You can type

```
. webuse set http://www.zzz.edu/users/~sue
```

`webuse` will become a synonym for `use http://www.zzz.edu/users/~sue/` for the rest of the session or until you give another `webuse` command.

When you set the URL, you may omit the trailing slash (as we did above), or you may include it:

```
. webuse set http://www.zzz.edu/users/~sue/
```

You may also omit `https://` or `http://`:

```
. webuse set www.zzz.edu/users/~sue
```

If you type `webuse set` without arguments, the URL will be reset to the default, https://www.stata-press.com/data/r19/:

```
. webuse set
```

Also see

[D] **frames use** — Load a set of frames from disk

[D] **sysuse** — Use shipped dataset

[D] **use** — Load Stata dataset

[U] 1.2.2 Example datasets

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